

OCBC Bank

First take: A beat, but lower DPS y/y and negative revisions for 2026 to keep stock range-bound, maintain Neutral

Neutral

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP
Price (24 Feb 26): S\$21.43
Price Target (Dec-26): S\$20.50

Our First Take: OCBC delivered a 7% beat in 4Q on the back of NIM/NII beat (+2bps q/q), better non-II (customer flow held better despite seasonality) and good cost control. Credit costs came in a touch higher, at 24bps for the quarter with coverage drawdown to 137% (vs. ~147% last qtr), which is still healthy. NPL ratio ticked up 5bps q/q, led by small increase q/q in gross corp/commercial NPA formation of S\$399mn (vs. S\$349mn last qtr and S\$282mn avg for 2024/25), likely led by Greater China. We await details during the briefing.

The key miss/disappointment was in capital return, and guidance thereof, which was the key reason for our downgrade last month ([link](#)). DPS of 99c for the year (vs. 101c in 2024 and JPMe for this year) underscored the point that management is willing to let DPS fluctuate with EPS. This is in-line with 60% payout guidance and about in-line with Bloomberg consensus. The statement regarding completion of S\$2.5bn capital return is in-line, and we interpret this as the bank utilizing part of the remaining ~S\$700mn (16c/share) for buybacks and paying out the rest as a special. CET1 stays strong at 15.1%, with management reiterating “Target 14% Group CET1”, in-line with previous statements. Yet, there is limited clarity on timing and mode of this CET1 optimization (buyback, dividend, organic growth or M&A). Hence, any clarification around this topic will go a long way in giving credence to the statement.

Guidance for 2026 is broadly in-line with our estimates, which are 4% below Street; but with an important departure. We forecast 18bps credit costs for 2026 but guidance is for 20-25bps. This suggests a negative skew of risks. Hence, we expect the Street to reduce estimates post these results. The stock is up 26% since end Oct-25 (vs. 13% STI), and a combination of DPS decline and likely negative revisions may lead to a partial reversal of some of the performance. The underlying trends at the bank remain good, hence we see a shallow bottom. Maintain N, with DBS and SGX as preferred picks in the sector, and UOB as key UW.

Key Positives

NIM improved 2bps q/q to 1.86%. Loan growth was seasonally strong with 4% q/q pick-up, supporting NII growth.

Key Negatives/Question Marks

Dividend missed our estimates.

See page 5 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

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Likely Changes to Consensus

We expect negative revisions from the Street post results.

Expected Stock Reaction

We expect a negative stock price reaction.

Conference Call Details

OCBC is holding a briefing at 9:30am SGT today. Please let us know if you'd like to register.

Table 1: OCBC: 4Q25 earnings review

P&L (\$mn)	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25A	4Q25E	YoY	QoQ	JPMe
Net Interest Income	2,455	2,345	2,283	2,226	2,296	2,222	-6%	3%	3%
Non-Interest Income	961	1,310	1,264	1,570	1,320	1,276	37%	-16%	3%
Net Fee Income	517	546	580	683	602	604	16%	-12%	0%
Operating Revenue	3,416	3,655	3,547	3,796	3,616	3,497	6%	-5%	3%
Operating Costs	(1,560)	(1,415)	(1,389)	(1,519)	(1,559)	(1,577)	0%	3%	-1%
PPOP	1,856	2,240	2,158	2,277	2,057	1,920	11%	-10%	7%
Provisions	(208)	(212)	(114)	(139)	(200)	(193)	-4%	44%	4%
Associates	245	274	263	279	261	302	7%	-6%	-14%
Amortization, tax, NCI	(206)	(419)	(491)	(439)	(373)	(394)	81%	-15%	-5%
Net Attributable Profit	1,687	1,883	1,816	1,978	1,745	1,636	3%	-12%	7%
Gross Loans	319,166	322,175	324,606	327,060	341,120	331,845	7%	4%	3%
Net Loans	315,096	317,885	320,413	322,729	336,692	327,496	7%	4%	3%
Deposits	390,687	402,732	406,943	410,596	428,286	419,478	10%	4%	2%
NPL	2,827	2,898	2,983	2,944	3,229	3,050	14%	10%	6%
LLR	4,070	4,290	4,193	4,331	4,428	4,349	9%	2%	2%
							Change in bps		
NIM	2.15%	2.04%	1.92%	1.84%	1.86%	1.82%	(29)	2	4
CIR	45.7%	38.7%	39.2%	40.0%	43.1%	45.1%	(255)	310	(198)
LDR	81.7%	80.0%	79.8%	79.7%	79.6%	79.1%	(205)	(1)	54
CASA Ratio	48.8%	48.9%	49.8%	50.3%	50.7%	50.4%	191	44	31
Credit Costs (bps)	27	26	11	17	24	23	(3)	7	1
NPL Ratio	0.89%	0.90%	0.92%	0.90%	0.95%	0.92%	6	5	3
Coverage Ratio	144%	148%	141%	147%	137%	143%	(682)	(1,000)	(544)
CET1 (Fully phased-in)	15.3%	15.5%	15.3%	15.0%	15.1%	15.0%	(22)	10	14
DPS (\$)	0.57	0.00	0.41	0.00	0.58	0.60	2%	NM	-3%

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Table 2: OCBC: FY25 earnings review

P&L (\$mn)	FY20A	FY21A	FY22A	FY23A	FY24A	FY25A	FY25E	YoY	JPMe
Net Interest Income	5,966	5,855	7,688	9,645	9,755	9,150	9,076	-6%	1%
Non-Interest Income	4,173	4,741	3,987	3,862	4,718	5,464	5,420	16%	1%
Net Fee Income	2,003	2,245	1,851	1,804	1,970	2,411	2,413	22%	0%
Operating Revenue	10,139	10,596	11,675	13,507	14,473	14,614	14,495	1%	1%
Operating Costs	(4,439)	(4,764)	(5,026)	(5,223)	(5,742)	(5,882)	(5,900)	2%	0%
PPOP	5,700	5,832	6,649	8,284	8,731	8,732	8,595	0%	2%
Provisions	(2,043)	(873)	(584)	(733)	(690)	(665)	(690)	-4%	-4%
Associates	612	824	978	953	994	1,077	1,118	8%	-4%
Amortization, tax, NCI	(683)	(925)	(1,295)	(1,483)	(1,448)	(1,722)	(1,711)	19%	1%
Net Attributable Profit	3,586	4,858	5,748	7,021	7,587	7,422	7,313	-2%	1%
Gross Loans	267,240	289,716	294,980	296,653	319,166	341,120	331,845	7%	3%
Net Loans	263,538	286,281	291,467	292,754	315,096	336,692	327,496	7%	3%
Deposits	314,907	342,395	350,081	363,770	390,687	428,286	419,478	10%	2%
NPL	3,917	4,215	3,383	2,805	2,827	3,229	3,050	14%	6%
LLR	3,702	3,435	3,513	3,899	4,070	4,428	4,349	9%	2%
Change in bps									
NIM	1.61%	1.54%	1.91%	2.28%	2.20%	1.91%	1.92%	(29)	(1)
CIR	43.8%	45.0%	43.0%	38.7%	39.7%	40.2%	40.7%	58	(45)
LDR	84.9%	84.6%	84.3%	81.5%	81.7%	79.6%	79.1%	(205)	54
CASA Ratio	60.3%	63.3%	51.8%	48.7%	48.8%	50.7%	50.4%	191	31
Credit Costs (bps)	77	31	20	25	22	20	19	(2)	1
NPL Ratio	1.47%	1.45%	1.15%	0.95%	0.89%	0.95%	0.92%	6	3
Coverage Ratio	95%	81%	104%	139%	144%	137%	143%	(684)	(545)
CET1 (Fully phased-in)	15.3%	15.5%	15.2%	15.9%	15.3%	15.1%	15.0%	(22)	14
DPS (\$)	0.32	0.53	0.68	0.82	1.01	0.99	1.01	-2%	-2%

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Neutral; Price Target: S\$20.50)*

Investment Thesis

We are Neutral on OCBC.

- The bank has built a multi-brand financial conglomerate in Asia, with Wing Hang, BoS, GEH and Bank of Ningbo being the main acquisitions/stake increases in the last 20 years, with Lion Global being a product of the merger between OCBC/GEH AMs. The group is generating 1.13% RoA with ~11x leverage in 2025.
- The track-record suggests OCBC is more likely to use excess capital to buy rather than increase payout significantly. While management is committed to the current S\$2.5bn capital return plan, visibility for further increases in payout is low in 1H26, with the bank guiding for limited shifts until end 2026.
- The bank has allowed DPS to move in line with EPS. We forecast ~S\$600mn of buybacks every year (FY26-27), which adds about 0.7% to total returns in 2026/27. However, buybacks could be lower given the bank's reluctance to buy back at significantly above book value.
- The bank is benefitting from significant inflows of funds into Singapore, and in SGD. The preference for NII growth suggests that the risks to NIM may be higher as rates reset lower.
- The bank's track record on inorganic growth could lead to near-term risks if growth in Greater China is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.
- Following the rally in the last 12M, risk-reward has moved closer to fair at current valuations.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of S\$20.5 is based on a fair P/B of 1.40x, assuming a normalized RoE of 12.2%, a risk-free rate of 4.1%, a cost of capital of 9.9% and a growth rate of 4.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, a meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which could drive faster growth at the group.

Downside risks include weaker than expected NIM, market share losses in wealth management, lack of increases in capital return, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 24 February 2026, unless otherwise indicated)

DBS Group Holdings(DBSM.SI/SS\$57.86/OW), Singapore Exchange(SGXL.SI/SS\$17.94/OW), United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI/SS\$37.20/UW)

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
09-Mar-23	OW	12.55	13.5
30-Mar-23	UW	12.53	11.5
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18
08-Aug-25	N	17.09	17.5
10-Sep-25	N	16.76	17
28-Nov-25	OW	18.27	20
09-Jan-26	N	20.17	20.5

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Feb 24, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
09-Mar-23	N	30.64	31
30-Mar-23	UW	30.54	27
05-Oct-23	UW	30.20	28
09-Dec-23	UW	28.73	27.5
13-Mar-24	N	30.46	30
03-Jul-24	OW	37.10	41
06-Oct-24	OW	38.04	42
10-Nov-24	OW	42.40	50
11-Feb-25	OW	45.38	51
23-Mar-25	OW	45.31	49
21-May-25	N	44.38	47
13-Jul-25	N	45.99	48
08-Aug-25	N	49.75	50.5
10-Sep-25	OW	50.88	56
28-Nov-25	OW	54.00	70

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Singapore Exchange (SGXL.SI, SGX SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
29-Nov-23	N	9.39	10
20-May-24	OW	9.24	10.5
22-Aug-24	N	10.60	10.5
12-Sep-24	UW	11.76	10.5
06-Oct-24	UW	11.68	11
28-Jan-25	UW	12.23	11.1
13-Feb-25	UW	13.66	11
09-Apr-25	N	12.02	11
27-Apr-25	UW	14.36	12.8
16-Jul-25	UW	15.67	14
10-Sep-25	N	16.35	16
28-Nov-25	OW	16.60	18.5
03-Feb-26	OW	17.56	19
24-Feb-26	OW	17.97	20

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Oct 17, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
30-Mar-23	N	29.95	28.5
05-Oct-23	N	28.07	28
09-Dec-23	N	27.58	27
13-Mar-24	N	28.28	30
03-Jul-24	N	31.65	32.5
06-Oct-24	N	31.86	34
10-Nov-24	OW	35.69	41
14-Jan-25	OW	36.80	43
23-Mar-25	N	37.95	40
21-May-25	N	35.40	37
13-Jul-25	N	36.86	38
08-Aug-25	N	35.81	36.5
10-Sep-25	UW	35.57	32.5
28-Nov-25	N	33.89	34
25-Jan-26	UW	39.50	34

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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